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General Comment

1: It's nonfunctional without theft

This new technology requires huge amounts of data to do what it does, to supposedly teach computers how to “draw” and “write” and “talk” like people, and that data isn't coming from nowhere. It's coming from all the information that's currently accessible online, including encyclopedias, periodicals and media broadcast websites, art community image libraries, creative writing online libraries, public record archives and any picture, published story, or social media post shared online. What this means, in short, is: if you have ANY sort of footprint of existence online, it's currently up for grabs for a tech company to use to teach their generators how to “make things.” And no one will be compensated for it.

On top of all this? It's not even actually Artificially Intelligent. “AI” is a sci-fi buzzword covering up the fact that these programs are merely extremely complicated average generators, without any real “cognition” or “understanding” behind them. They are the equivalent of a trained pigeon, which receives seeds when it pecks the word “FOOD” on a screen: it does not know “how to read”, it does not understand that the word “FOOD” means anything edible, it has merely been conditioned to expect a result when it interacts with a particular shape of letters. They cannot, and will not ever understand the full breadth of meaningfulness of communication that comes from real human beings and what they produce.

2: It's Horrible for the Environment

The development phase of GPT-4, the currently most advanced Large Language Model Text Generator to date, put electricity supply demands on power plants that created carbon emissions output equivalent to powering over 1,300 homes for a year. And when it's working to process inputs, it produces more, with GPT-3's daily usage profile producing 8.4 tons of CO2 annually. And all those data centers need water to cool. According to the Washington Post in collaboration with the University of California, Riverside, if 1 in 10 Americans used ChatGPT weekly for a year, it would require the amount of water equal to that used by the entirety of Rhode Island for 1.5 days. And whether you like it or not, the anthropogenic impact of human industrial activity on the environment is a known and proven scientific fact. Waking up and seeing news briefs of the city of Los Angeles literally looking like the gateway to Hell should be illustrative enough of the dire consequences of neglecting to manage water consumption.

3: It Devalues the Essential Human Expression of Creativity

No matter what your philosophical definition of “meaningful art” is, it is an activity that has intrinsic value because it's something that only human beings do. But what “AI” algorithmic generation does is say that the only art that means anything or has any value is the art that “looks good enough” to be a product. There is no space in AI Algorithmic Generated art for abstraction, impressionism, stylization and any of the innumerable ways that the human mind looks at the world, and attempts to outwardly express the act of interpreting it. For AI, there is only the pre-existing library of images, and what is most frequently occurring to draw from.

There was a study recently that attempted to prove that the average layperson “likes AI art” because it manages to reach the same level of a mediocrity as mundane consumer decoration, and the average person is too stupid to know what “critically worthy” art is anyways. But not only is that insulting of every person's ability to appreciate the many different kinds of art, it's also a screen for a deeper, more serious issue. The issue at stake in the implementation of AI is not only “what art is good enough to be consumed” but rather “do humans deserve to do art at all, or should it be handed over to mechanization?” If a computer algorithm can generate an image that is good enough for business purposes, there's no reason for a human to make a painting. Why should a person spend time writing story if a machine can do it

faster and cheaper? Every action that can be done sufficiently by automation MUST be turned over entirely to automation to do. Every human activity must be proven to have some kind of quantifiable value, and if it does not measure up, something more “productive” must be done instead. If a computer can make the art, write the story, or film the movie for free, then all the painters, writers, poets, cartoonists, actors, filmmakers, and everyone else must do something else worthy of pay

It is with these points in mind that I insist that US regulation treats "AI" as the dangerous, wasteful novelty that it truly is.

- * I do not believe AI holds a place in the future of the US
- * AI steals from my livelihood as an American and profits off of theft
- * AI is overhyped and is fleecing the eyes of the American public.